

PROJECT REPORT

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Infographic

For this task I used Canva, a free and beginner-friendly design tool, to create a single infographic covering three topics. The first section explained what digital literacy means — using technology smartly, finding information responsibly, and staying safe online. The second section listed helpful student tools: Google Docs, Canva, GitHub, and LinkedIn, each with a short note on why it matters. The third section covered safe internet practices like using strong passwords, avoiding suspicious links, never sharing personal information publicly, and enabling two-factor authentication.

The most interesting part was realising how much thought goes into making information look simple and clean. The main difficulty I faced was choosing the right colours — I kept changing the palette because the design either looked too plain or too cluttered. Eventually I learned that keeping things minimal makes the information much easier to read.

Task 2 – Student Digital Portfolio

I created and set up profiles on three platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. On GitHub, I created a Profile README with my name, branch, year, and a short sentence about what I hope to learn. On LinkedIn, I filled in my Education section with my degree, institution, and expected graduation year. On Kaggle, I created an account to explore data science content and future competitions.

GitHub will be my coding portfolio throughout college, LinkedIn will grow into my professional resume, and Kaggle will push me to explore data and machine learning beyond the classroom. Setting these up in first year itself means by the time placements come around, I will already have a consistent online presence rather than building one from scratch under pressure.

Task 3 – Coding & Collaboration Platforms

For Part A, I used CodeChef to practise coding. I created an account and completed a beginnerlevel challenge to get familiar with how competitive programming platforms work. CodeChef is widely used by students across India and is also used by companies to test candidates during recruitment, so learning to navigate it early made a lot of sense to me.

For Part B, I built a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms with five questions — including multiple choice and short answer types. I shared the form, collected responses, and analysed the results through the automatically linked Google Sheet. Google Forms generated visual summaries and charts on its own, which made the analysis quick and straightforward. This experience taught me how to create structured surveys, collect data, and read results — skills that will be useful for academic projects and research throughout my degree.

Task 4 – Professional Email & Digital Etiquette

For Part A, I drafted two professional emails. The first was from a student to a professor requesting an assignment deadline extension due to illness — it included a clear subject line, a polite explanation, a request for specific extra days, and a proper sign-off. The second was from a student to an internship coordinator expressing interest in a summer internship — it introduced the student, briefly mentioned relevant skills and platforms set up, and closed with a resume attachment offer.

For Part B, I created a Social Media Do's and Don'ts checklist with five points on each side. The Do's included things like keeping LinkedIn updated, thinking before posting, and crediting others for their work. The Don'ts covered sharing personal details publicly, posting impulsively, and accepting requests from unknown people.

For the report section, I described a scenario where a manager sends a vague WhatsApp message — 'Let's push the deadline' — and half the team thinks it means more time while the other half works overtime to finish early. The fix was simple: a specific message with the exact new deadline and a confirmation request. Clear digital communication saves time, avoids conflict, and keeps everyone on the same page.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness: UPI Fraud

For my case study I chose UPI and online payment fraud, which is one of the most common cybercrimes targeting college students in India today. The scam typically works like this: a fraudster contacts the victim pretending to be from a bank, a delivery company, or a government office. They create urgency — 'your account will be blocked' or 'your refund is ready' — and then send a UPI collect request. They tell the victim to enter their PIN to receive money, but entering the PIN on a collect request actually sends money. By the time the victim realises this, the money is gone.

What surprised me the most while researching this was that educated, tech-savvy people fall for it too. The scammers study human psychology, use fake IDs, and speak very confidently. The detail that shocked me the most was about the collect request — I did not know that entering your PIN sends money rather than receives it. That one small misunderstanding has cost thousands of people their savings, and I could easily have been one of them.

The one habit I am personally changing is stopping the use of public Wi-Fi for anything financial. I used to open my banking app and make UPI payments on the open network at my college canteen without thinking twice. After learning how easily someone on the same unsecured network can spy on your data, I will only use my mobile data for payments and sensitive logins from now on. This research did not just give me information — it gave me a real reason to be more careful every day. For anyone who faces cybercrime, the National Cyber Crime Portal is cybercrime.gov.in and the helpline number is 1930.

End of Report – Ayush Varshney | 25BCE10938